

SIMPLE SENTENCES

A simple sentence is a sentence that has one subject-verb pair.

^S Freshwater ^V boils at 100 degrees Celsius

PRACTICE 4

Recognizing Sentences

- A** Work with a partner. Read each group of words and write **S** (sentence) or **NS** (not a sentence).

- NS 1. Is very hot today.
S 2. It is very hot today.
_____ 3. My new classmate from Brazil.
_____ 4. He speaks three languages fluently.
_____ 5. Is very competitive.
_____ 6. Hurry up, please.
_____ 7. He wants to start his own business.
_____ 8. He isn't married.
_____ 9. Enjoys music, especially pop.
_____ 10. Don't send text messages in class.
_____ 11. The books expensive.
_____ 12. Go to the course website.

PRACTICE 6

Editing Subject and Verb Errors

Work alone or with a partner. Find the seven missing subjects and verbs in the paragraph. Make corrections.

Larry's Bad Habit

My friend Larry ^{has} a bad habit. He never on time to anything. Arrives ten minutes late everywhere. Larry always an excuse. "I missed the bus." "My alarm clock didn't ring." "My watch stopped." Uses each excuse at least twice a week. I know them all. Whenever Larry rushes in—ten minutes late, of course—and starts to say, "Sorry I'm late, but I . . . , " I can finish the sentence for him. However, I recently discovered a new strategy. If the movie starts at 7:00, I tell Larry it starts at 6:45. Then he early! Larry's bad habit not a problem for me any longer.



Analyzing Your Writing for Verbs

Here are some simple rules to follow when you analyze your writing for verbs.

RULES	EXAMPLES
1. Label two- and three-word verb forms as a single verb.	My sister ^V is studying French this semester. My brother ^V has been living in Mexico since last year.
2. Label only main verb forms as verbs. Do not label infinitives (that is, verb forms which begin with <i>to</i>).	My grandmother ^V wants ^X to live in Florida. Florida ^V is ^X a nice place to live
3. Do not label verb forms that are used as adjectives or nouns.	A duck ^V is swimming ^X in the hotel swimming pool.

The subject (S) in a simple sentence may be a single subject (consisting of a word, noun phrase, or subject pronoun) or it may be **compound**. That is, it may consist of two or more subjects (nouns, noun phrases, or pronouns) joined by connecting words like *and* or *or*:

^S **My brother** ^S **and I** are completely different.

^S **Mary** ^S **or Rita** will meet you at the airport.

The verb (V) in a simple sentence may also be compound. It may consist of two or more verb forms joined by connecting words such as *and* or *or*. However, these are simple sentences because they have only one subject-verb pair.

They ^V **laughed** ^V **and cried** at the same time.

He ^V **walks** ^V **or cycles** to work.



Connecting Words: *And* and *Or*

You often need to connect words or groups of words in a sentence. One way to do this is to use a connecting word. Connecting words are called **conjunctions**. There are many conjunctions in English. Two of the most common ones are *and* and *or*. They have different meanings.

RULES	EXAMPLES
1. <i>And</i> joins two or more similar things in affirmative sentences.	I like Chinese and Italian food. We have class on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays.
2. <i>Or</i> connects two or more similar things in negative sentences.	I don't like warm milk or cold coffee. We don't have class on Tuesdays or Thursdays.
3. <i>Or</i> also connects two or more choices or alternatives.	I would like to go to London, Rome, or Paris on my next vacation. (<i>I cannot go to all three places. I will choose one.</i>) My father or my mother will meet me at the airport. (<i>This sentence means that only one person will come to the airport.</i>) COMPARE: My father and my mother will meet me at the airport. (<i>This sentence means that two people will come to the airport.</i>)

PRACTICE 10 Using *And* and *Or*

Complete each sentence with *and* or *or*.

- I can speak and understand English.
- I can't speak Tagalog _____ Vietnamese.
- My mother is proud of my sister _____ me.
- Would you like to listen to music _____ watch a movie?
(*You can do only one.*)
- You can walk there _____ take the bus. (*You can do only one.*)
- My uncle, a talented artist, paints _____ makes sculptures.
- Does your English class meet on Monday, Wednesday, _____
Friday, _____ on Tuesday, Thursday, _____ Friday?
- Last year my stepmother graduated from college _____ started her own business.

PRACTICE 11 Combining Sentences with *And* and *Or*

- A** Read each pair of sentences. Then use *and* or *or* to combine them into a simple sentence.

1. My brother speaks German. My brother speaks Japanese.

My brother speaks German and Japanese.

2. Marie got an A in Biology 101. Marie got a B in English 103.

3. You can fly from Paris to Amsterdam. You can take a train from Paris to Amsterdam. (*You can't do both.*)

4. Marta is married. Marta has two children.

5. She may major in math. She may major in business. (*She can't major in both.*)

6. Should we go out tonight? Should we stay home tonight?



COMPOUND SENTENCES

In Chapter 1, you learned about simple sentences. A simple sentence has one subject-verb (S-V) combination. Another kind of sentence, called a compound sentence, has two or more subject-verb combinations.

A **compound sentence** is composed of at least two simple sentences joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction. A compound sentence has this “pattern”:

S V COORD S V
CONJ

He heard happy singing, so he dropped the other two rice balls into the hole.

COORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

There are seven coordinating conjunctions in English: *and*, *but*, *so*, *or*, *for*, *nor*, and *yet*. In this chapter, you will study the first four. Coordinating conjunctions are sometimes called *fan boys* because their first letters spell those words: *for*, *and*, *nor*, *but*, *or*, *yet*, and *so*.

COORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS	EXAMPLES
And joins sentences that are alike.	He dropped a rice ball, and it rolled into a hole in the ground.
But joins sentences that are opposite or show contrast.	They were happy, but they were poor.
So joins sentences when the second sentence expresses the result of something described in the first sentence.	The greedy man wanted all of the mice's gold, so he pretended to be a cat.
Or joins sentences that give choices or alternatives.	He could choose a big box, or he could choose a small one.

Use a comma before a coordinating conjunction in compound sentences only. Do not use a comma to join two words or two phrases in a simple sentence.

COMPOUND SENTENCES
(COMMA)

The old man was a generous person, and he liked to help others.

The mice were having a party, and they asked the old man to join them.

He took the small box, and he went home.

SIMPLE SENTENCES
(NO COMMA)

The old man was a generous person and liked to help others.

The mice were having a party and asked the old man to join them.

He took the small box and went home.

PRACTICE 8 Identifying Compound Sentences

- A** Work with a partner. Draw a box around each coordinating conjunction in the model on page 40. Take turns explaining why some of the conjunctions have commas, but others do not.
- B** Read "Seguin's Goat." Which of the sentences are compound sentences and which are simple sentences? Write CS or SS. Then add commas as needed.

Seguin's Goat A Folktale from France

- SS 1. A long time ago, high in the Alps, an old man lived with his goat, Blanchette.
- _____ 2. She was a wonderful white goat and was very kind to her master, Monsieur Seguin.
- _____ 3. They had lived together for many years.
- _____ 4. Blanchette was always fastened to a tree.
- _____ 5. She was often sad and sometimes she didn't eat her food.
- _____ 6. Every day, she looked at the big mountains and dreamed of being free to explore them.
- _____ 7. One day, she asked her master for more freedom.
- _____ 8. "You can tie me with a longer rope or you can build a special enclosure for me," said Blanchette.
- _____ 9. At first, he tied her with a longer rope but Blanchette was still sad.
- _____ 10. A few days later, he built a special enclosure.
- _____ 11. For a while, Blanchette was very happy about this decision but soon the enclosure seemed very small in front of the big mountains.
- _____ 12. One summer morning, Blanchette decided to leave for the mountains so she jumped out of the enclosure and ran away.
- _____ 13. "I am free," she said.
- _____ 14. She ate many varieties of plants and enjoyed meeting new friends.
- _____ 15. All day, she ran in the Alps.
- _____ 16. Finally, the sun set behind the hills.

PRACTICE 14 Writing Compound Sentences

- A** Connect each pair of sentences with *and*, *but*, *or*, or *so*. Add a comma as needed. For some, there may be more than one answer.

1. Canada has two official languages. Everything is printed in both English and French.

Canada has two official languages, so everything is printed in both English and French.

2. There are several hundred languages in the world. Not all of them have a written form.

3. Chinese is spoken by more people. English is spoken in more countries.

4. There are about one million words in English. Most people use only about ten thousand of them.

5. French used to be the language of international diplomacy. Now it is English.

6. International companies are growing. Bilingual workers are always needed.

7. Young people should know a second language. They will be at a disadvantage in the international job market.

B Complete each compound sentence with your own idea.

1. My brother and I are identical twins, but our personalities are very different.

2. We are both tall, and _____
-

3. He is very creative, but _____
-

4. I was born a few minutes before my brother, so _____

5. Our mother used to tell us, "Stop fighting, or _____
_____."
6. We fought a lot as children, but now _____

PRACTICE 10

Writing Compound Sentences

On a separate sheet of paper, write compound sentences using the coordinating conjunctions you have learned. Follow the instructions.

1. Write a sentence that tells one thing you like to do and one thing you don't like to do. (Use *but*.)

2. Write a sentence that tells the results of each clause. Begin each sentence with *I am / I was*. . . . (Use *so* in all three sentences.)

- a. being born in (your country)

I was born in Russia, so I speak Russian.

- b. being the oldest / youngest / middle / only child in your family

- c. being a lazy / hardworking student

3. Write a sentence that tells two things you do every morning after you get up. (Use *and*.)

4. Write a sentence that tells two things you might do during your next vacation. (Use *or*.)

INDEPENDENT AND DEPENDENT CLAUSES

An **independent clause** is a group of words that has a subject and a verb and expresses a complete thought. It can stand alone as a sentence by itself.

S **V**
Paris has excellent art museums.

S **V**
We finished our homework.

This is a simple sentence that is also an independent clause.

The professor provided his email address.

This is a compound sentence with two independent clauses.

The professor provided his email address, but some students did not write it down.

A **dependent clause** is also a group of words that has a subject and a verb. Unlike an independent clause, however, a dependent clause always begins with an introductory word known as a **subordinator**.

SUBORDINATOR **S** **V**
because Washington, D.C., has excellent museums

SUBORDINATOR **S** **V**
after Mrs. Martinez explained the homework

A dependent clause does not express a complete thought. It is not a complete sentence, so it cannot stand alone. To be correct, it must appear in a sentence with an independent clause. Together, the two clauses express a complete thought and form a complex sentence.

INDEPENDENT CLAUSE **DEPENDENT CLAUSE**
Art students should visit Paris because it has excellent art museums.

DEPENDENT CLAUSE **INDEPENDENT CLAUSE**
After we finished our homework, we watched TV for a while.

Subordinators

A dependent adverb clause always begins with a subordinating conjunction, or **subordinator**. There are different kinds of subordinators. Time subordinators begin a clause that tells *when* something happens. Reason subordinators begin a clause that tells *why* something happens. Purpose subordinators begin a clause that tells *the purpose* or objective of an event or action. Conditional subordinators begin a clause that tells *the condition* under which something can occur.

SUBORDINATORS				
after	before	that	when	which
although	even though	though	whenever	while
as, just as	how	unless	where	who
as if	if	until	wherever	whom
as soon as	since	what	whether	whose
because	so that			

PRACTICE 7

Identifying Independent and Dependent Clauses

Look at each group of words from a student paragraph. If it is an independent clause, write *IC* and put a period at the end. If it is a dependent clause, write *DC* and circle the subordinator.

- DC 1. Before I go to work
- IC 2. I take a walk around the block.
- _____ 3. The exercise wakes up my body and clears my mind
- _____ 4. It's hard to do this in the winter
- _____ 5. When I go to work
- _____ 6. It is still dark
- _____ 7. After I get home from work
- _____ 8. It is dark again
- _____ 9. I can always take a walk on weekends, even in the winter
- _____ 10. When it is raining, of course
- _____ 11. I never go out
- _____ 12. On rainy days, as soon as the alarm clock rings
- _____ 13. I turn over and go back to sleep

COMPLEX SENTENCES

SUBORDINATORS	EXAMPLES
Time Subordinators	
after	He goes to school after he finishes work.
as*	I entered the classroom as the professor was beginning her lecture.
as soon as	The professor stopped talking as soon as I entered the room.
before	Before you attend college, you have to fill out an application.
since*	It has been an hour since the test started.
until	We can't leave the room until everyone has finished the test.
when	When you start college, you sometimes have to take a placement test.
whenever	Whenever I don't sleep well, I feel sick the next day.
while	I felt nervous while I was taking my first exam.
Reason Subordinators	
as*	As the number of scholarships is limited, it is important to submit your application as soon as possible.
because	I did well on my exam because I studied hard.
since*	Since this is a required course, you must take it.
Purpose Subordinator	
so that	I studied hard so that I would do well on the exam.
Condition Subordinators	
if	If your professor gives a list of class rules, you must be sure to follow them.
unless	Do not use a dictionary in class unless your professor allows you to do so.

CONCESSION SUBORDINATORS	EXAMPLES
although	Although I had studied all night, I failed the test.
even though	Our house is quite comfortable even though it is small.
though	Though the citizens had despised the old regime, they disliked the new government even more.

DIRECT OPPOSITION SUBORDINATORS	EXAMPLES
whereas	San Francisco is cool during the summer, whereas Los Angeles is generally hot.
while	While most homes in San Francisco do not have air conditioning, it is a necessity in Los Angeles.

Note that in complex sentences with time clauses, the independent and dependent clauses can be in any order.

- If the independent clause comes first, don't use a comma.

INDEPENDENT NO COMMA DEPENDENT
 We ran for shelter as soon as it started to rain.

- If the dependent clause comes first, put a comma after it.

DEPENDENT COMMA INDEPENDENT
 As soon as it started to rain, we ran for shelter.

PRACTICE 7 Identifying and Analyzing Complex Sentences

- A** Underline three complex sentences with time clauses in the writing model on page 103.

- B** Underline the independent clauses and double underline the dependent clauses. Circle the subordinators. Add a comma as needed.

1. When students email their professors, they often expect an immediate reply.
2. It is usually impossible to get a response right away because professors are very busy people.
3. If you have not received an answer within two business days you should send a second email.
4. After you have received a helpful response send a follow-up email to thank the professor.

5. Check your school email regularly since your instructors may send out important notices.
6. Whenever you see the word *test* in the subject line of an email you had better pay attention.
7. Do not be absent on the day of a test unless you have received permission from your instructor.
8. The students were silent as the professor handed out their test.
9. The students worked on the test problems until the teacher told them to stop.
10. As soon as the instructor told them to stop writing they put down their pencils.
11. After the teacher collected the tests she dismissed the class.
12. Before she left she promised to post their test scores in the grade book of their course website.

PRACTICE 8

Writing Complex Sentences

- A** Combine the independent clauses in Column A with the dependent clauses in Column B to make complex sentences. Then write the sentences on a separate sheet of paper in order as a paragraph. Use correct capitalization and punctuation.

COLUMN A

- c 1. you will not be late for early morning classes
2. begin the process by deciding what to wear the next day
3. then get out of bed in the morning instead of sleeping an extra five or ten minutes
4. you should keep your alarm as far from your bed as possible
5. stick to a two-minute limit to save not only water but also time
6. the final step requires you to bring your breakfast to class

COLUMN B

- a. as soon as your alarm clock rings
- b. unless your professor has rules against food in the classroom
- ☒ c. if you follow several time-efficient steps
- d. then when you are in the shower
- e. because it will force you to get up and stay up
- f. before you go to bed at night

PRACTICE 7**Analyzing Complex Sentences**

- B** Add a logical independent clause to each of the dependent clauses. Make sure you punctuate each sentence correctly.

1. I cannot register for classes until I pay my tuition.
2. Unless I take 12 units each term _____.
5. Because I had to look for a part-time job _____.
6. _____ if I want to get to school on time.
9. When I left my country _____.